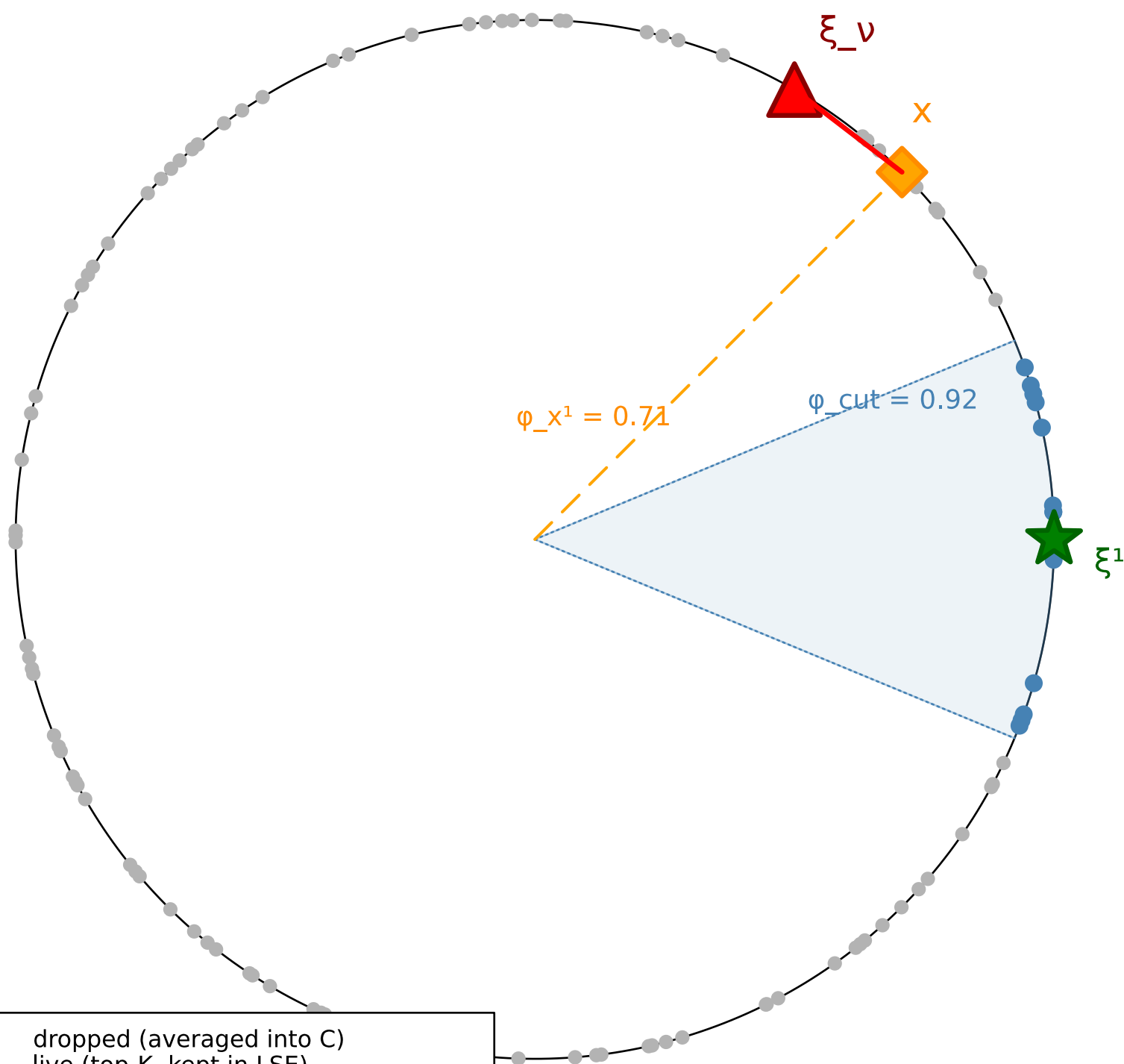


$$\varphi(\xi_v, \xi^1) = 0.50 < \varphi_{\text{cut}} \rightarrow \text{dropped} \quad | \quad \varphi(\xi_v, x) = 0.97 \rightarrow \text{dominates chain's local energy}$$



- dropped (averaged into C)
- live (top-K, kept in LSE)
- ★  $\xi^1$  (target)
- ◆ chain  $x$
- ▲  $\xi_v$  (closest dropped  $\rightarrow$  escape route)

2-D schematic of the N-sphere geometry (high-N analogue: perpendicular space has many directions)